A brief history: communication events

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Some events in the history of communication are recorded in the following boxes:

1956: Channel 9 started broadcasting, Australia ◯	1923: Wireless radio started broadcasting, Australia ◯	1838: Samuel Morse invented telegraph, USA ◯
1880: Telephone exchange opened in Melbourne, Australia ◯	1968: Australia linked to global satellite system ◯	1986: Optical fibre cable layed between Sydney and Melbourne ◯
1990: Phonecards introduced by Telstra, Australia ◯	1993: Digital mobile phones introduced, Australia ◯	1920: Radio broadcasts of voices began ◯
620: Chinese court circular called a pao appeared, China ◯	1876: Alexander Bell invented short distance telephone, USA ◯	1892: Automatic telephone exchange operated, USA ◯
1890: Heinrich Hertz built transmitter and receiver, Germany ◯	1998: Guglielmo Marconi sent radio morse code message, Italy ◯	60 BC: Roman gazette Acte Diurna displayed in public places, Italy ◯
1926: John Baird showed black and white television, Scotland ◯	1456: Johann Gutenberg printed books with movable type, Germany ◯	1795: Semaphore system (= flags on posts) took 2 min for 240 km, France ◯
1948: Vinyl record used to record music ◯	1615: Newspaper 'Frankfurter Zeitung' published, Germany ◯	750: Books were printed, China ◯
5000 BC: Message sticks carried simple information, Australia ◯	7000 BC: Drum beats conveyed short messages across jungle, Africa ◯	105: Tshai Lun write on paper made from bark and bamboo, China ◯
1084 BC: Fall of Troy news relayed by chain of fires to Greece ◯	2000 BC: Aztecs, Babylonians, Chinese, Egyptians wrote in pictures ◯	1889: Almon Strowger patented dial telephone system, USA ◯
1464: State post delivered mainly official mail, France ◯	1939: John Baird showed colour television, Scotland ◯	1935: Tape recorder shown in Berlin, Germany ◯

1 Order the events mentioned above. Write '1' in the circle of the earliest, then '2' in the circle of the next event and so on.

2 On the back of this sheet or on a separate sheet of paper, draw a timeline showing the events mentioned above. Add any other events or devices you can think of.

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3 Suggest two differences between early and more recent communication devices.

4 Suggest another difference if you can.

5 State one early and one late exception to your generalised differences.

6 For each of the properties listed in the table below, list three communication devices that have that property.

Reaches many people	Reaches only one person	Travels very fast	Can travel a great distance	Can carry much information

7 Choose one of the devices mentioned in the brief history of communication events. Imagine there is a person who has never heard of this device. Write a procedure telling that person how to use it.

8 Select a long distance communication device and explain how it might send your word to a receiver.

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